Activity 07 - Policy, Ethics and Escalation at Meridian Hospitality

Course: Mastering The Art of Conflict Resolution to Foster Team Collaboration and Success (TGS-2023021752) Duration: 55 minutes Materials: Policy-routing worksheet | evidence checklist Output: A policy-aligned case routing decision, protection plan, evidence-preservation checklist and neutral notification draft.

Objective

Distinguish resolvable disagreement from conduct requiring formal, confidential escalation.

Psychological-safety boundary

Use only the fictional case. Do not require anyone to disclose a personal conflict. Any participant may call a pause or request another role. This learning activity does not replace organisational policy, HR advice or legal advice.

Scenario

At Meridian Hospitality, employee Farah reports that colleague Leon has repeatedly made jokes about her religion in a team chat. She fears that complaining will affect shift allocation because Leon is close to the duty manager. A supervisor suggests putting both employees in a room to 'clear the air'. Learners must decide the immediate response, authorised channel, confidentiality boundary, interim support and documentation required under organisational policy. This activity is educational and not legal advice.

Detailed instructions

Role cards

Give each participant only their own role before the first round. Observers use the checklist.

Farah | Reporting Employee

Goal: be safe, heard and protected from retaliation. Private brief: Wants the conduct to stop and is anxious about who will see the report.

Ravi | Supervisor

Goal: respond promptly within authority. Private brief: Must not investigate beyond competence or force face-to-face reconciliation.

HR Case Lead

Goal: run a fair policy process. Private brief: Explains scope, privacy, support, neutral fact-finding and next updates.

1. Read without investigating. Review the Meridian Hospitality report and identify only the immediate routing decision. Do not try to prove or disprove the allegation in the workshop.

2. Identify risk categories. Mark possible harassment, discrimination, retaliation, safety, data-protection, employment and misconduct concerns. Treat them as concerns requiring checks, not legal findings.

3. Locate the controlling documents. List the grievance, harassment, disciplinary, whistleblowing, data-protection and record-retention policies that the responsible owner should consult.

4. Screen urgency and protection. Decide whether separation, roster changes, security, medical support, EAP, a support person or another interim measure is required without penalising the reporter.

5. Choose the reporting route. Select the designated internal owner and an alternative route where the direct manager is involved. Record why informal mediation is or is not suitable.

6. Preserve evidence. Identify relevant messages, rosters, CCTV, witness names and access logs. Preserve them lawfully, limit access and avoid unnecessary copying.

7. Protect confidentiality. Apply need-to-know access, secure storage, neutral filenames and a clear purpose. Do not promise complete secrecy or circulate personal data casually.

8. Plan neutral fact-finding. Set impartial ownership, comparable questions, response opportunity, a reasonable timeline and documentation expectations.

9. Draft the notification. Write a short acknowledgement that states receipt, immediate safety action, next process step, contact person, confidentiality boundary and non-retaliation expectation.

10. Test fairness. Check support for reporter, respondent and witnesses; conflicts of interest; opportunity to respond; and proportionality of interim measures.

11. Escalate for advice. Record where HR, senior management, a union, legal counsel, a regulator or emergency service may be needed. The activity does not provide legal advice.

12. Peer audit. Another group uses the checklist to identify one gap in routing, protection, evidence handling or fairness.

Suggested timing

- 5 minutes - Read and risk-category screen
- 8 minutes - Policy and urgency review
- 8 minutes - Routing and interim protection
- 7 minutes - Evidence and privacy plan
- 7 minutes - Fact-finding plan
- 8 minutes - Neutral notification
- 7 minutes - Peer fairness audit

Discussion questions

- Why is immediate informal mediation inappropriate as the default response?
- What can Ravi promise-and what must he not promise-about confidentiality?
- What records and personal data are necessary, accurate and restricted?
- What interim support and anti-retaliation monitoring should be arranged?

Submission

Submit the completed worksheet and checklist. Use role names rather than real personal data, mark unresolved information as unknown and retain the artefact only through the approved course channel.

Debrief

The response activates the correct policy channel, protects safety and fairness, limits data access and defines non-retaliation follow-up.